

The 30 provisions of the UDHR	
1:	All humans are born free and equal.
2:	Everybody is entitled to rights without discrimination.
3:	All people have the right to life, liberty, and safety.
4:	No one should be kept as a slave or in servitude.
5:	There should be no torture or other inhuman treatment.
6:	Everyone has the right to be recognized as a person in law.
7:	The law should be the same for everybody.
8:	Everyone may access legal help to protect their rights.
9:	No one can arrest or exile anyone without good reason.
10:	People have the right to a fair, impartial public trial.
11:	Everyone is innocent until they are proved guilty.
12:	No one should attack a person's privacy or reputation.
13:	People have freedom of movement in their own country.
14:	Everyone has the right to seek asylum abroad.
15:	We all have the right to a nationality.
16:	Men and women can marry and have children.
17:	All people have the right to own property.
18:	Freedom of thought is everybody's right.
19:	People should have freedom of opinion and expression.
20:	Everyone has the right to freedom of peaceful assembly.
21:	Government authority should be based on free elections.
22:	State social security should be provided when needed.
23:	All people have a right to work and to fair pay.
24:	Everyone should get leisure time, including paid holidays.
25:	Adequate food and shelter are a basic human right.
26:	Access to education is everyone's right.
27:	We should be able to protect our artistic creations.
28:	All these freedoms should be available worldwide.
29:	We have a duty to protect other people's rights.
30:	No state or persons can take away these rights.

of backgrounds and expertise. Among the nine were René Cassin, a French lawyer who had fled the Nazis; Charles Habib Malik, a Lebanese philosopher; Peng Chung Chang, a Chinese academic; Hernán Santa Cruz, a judge from Chile; and Charles Dukes, a British trade unionist. It was chaired by Roosevelt's widow, Eleanor. The final draft of the UDHR was completed in 1948. On December 10 that year, the UN General Assembly sitting in Paris (the UN's New York headquarters was not yet built) voted on resolution 217, entitled "the International Bill of Human Rights." The resolution was passed with 48 states voting in favor, none voting against, and eight choosing to abstain, including South Africa (see box, right). Every year, World Human Rights Day is marked around the globe on December 10.

A declaration of principles
The UDHR is not a legal document and, unlike a treaty, countries are not obliged to follow its terms as a matter of international law. Rather, it is a declaration of principles about what rights ought to be protected globally. The UDHR was a response to the tragedy of World War II, during which, as the Declaration states, "disregard and contempt for human rights have resulted in barbarous acts which have outraged the conscience of mankind." In this respect, the advocacy of human rights also has the practical purpose of promoting peace between nations: as the UDHR's preamble notes, this helps support "the development of friendly relations between nations."
Human rights are also justified as being universal on the grounds of natural law, which the ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle explained as a body of unchanging